Fiscal Impact Statement

Legislative Council Staff

Nonpartisan Services for Colorado's Legislature

AMENDMENT 84: MAIL BALLOT VOTER IDENTIFICATION

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Summary Information

Overview. The measure requires that voters add additional identifying information when returning mail ballots.

Types of impacts. The measure is projected to affect the following areas:

- State Revenue
- State Expenditures
- Local Government

Disclaimer. This fiscal impact statement has been prepared for a statewide ballot measure appearing at the 2026 statewide election. Any appropriations required to implement this measure will be addressed through the annual or supplemental budget process if this measure is approved by voters. For more information about this measure, please see the ballot information booklet.

Table 1
State Fiscal Impacts

Type of Impact	Current Year FY 2026-27	Budget Year FY 2027-28	Out Year FY 2028-29
State Revenue	$0	$0	$0
State Expenditures (Cash Funds)	$1,241,228	$260,000	$555,500
Transferred Funds	$0	$0	$0
Change in TABOR Refunds	$0	$0	$0
Change in State FTE	0.0 FTE	0.0 FTE	0.0 FTE

Amendment 84

Summary of Measure

Under current law, voters add their signature and self-affirm their mail ballots before returning to the county clerk. The measure requires additional forms of identification for mail ballots, including either the last for digits of a social security number, Colorado Real Identification number, or Colorado driver's license number. If a voter fails to fill out the additional identification, or if an election judge cannot confirm the identification information when reviewing the mail ballot, the ballot is sent back to the voter to cure any discrepancy. Until the discrepancy is resolved the ballot is not counted.

State Revenue

Under current law, the Department of State is authorized to adjust fees so that the revenue generated approximates its direct and indirect costs. The department is primarily funded through business filing fees. To cover the costs described in the State Expenditures section below, fees may need to be raised to cover all or some of the costs of this measure. The fees affected, the timing of any increase, and the actual amount of fee charges will be set administratively by the department based on cash fund balance and total program costs.

State Expenditures

The Department of State will have costs of $1.2 million in FY 2026-27, $260,000 in FY 2027-28, $555,500 in FY 2028-29, and varying amounts in future years based on the election cycle. These costs, paid from the Department of State Cash Fund, are summarized in Table 2 and discussed below.

Table 2
State Expenditures
Department of State

Cost Component	Current Year FY 2026-27	Budget Year FY 2027-28	Out Year FY 2028-29
Initial Outreach Campaign	$100,000	$200,000	$0
Election Information and Material	$0	$60,000	$20,000
County Reimbursement	$1,141,228	$0	$535,500
Total Costs	**$1,241,228**	**$260,000**	**$555,500**
Total FTE	**0.0 FTE**	**0.0 FTE**	**0.0 FTE**

Public Outreach and Election Information

The Department of State will need to inform voters of the changes to mail voting across the state. This requires an initial outreach and communication campaign with a cost of $100,000 in FY 2026-27, and $200,000 in FY 2027-28. In future years, the department will also have ongoing workload and costs to conduct voter outreach and provide election information and materials, estimated at $20,000 per election, with this cost incurred for each presidential primary, statewide primary, and general election. These ongoing costs will vary based on the election calendar.

County Reimbursement

Counties will also have additional costs, a portion of which will be reimbursed by the state. This is estimated to cost $1,141,228 in the first year, and $535,500 in years when there is a general election.

Local Government

The new verification process under the measure will increase county spending by up to $2.5 million in the 2026-27 budget year and up to $1.2 million in future years. About 45 percent of these county costs will be reimbursed by the state government. These costs are driven from several new requirements. First, election judges must review identification numbers provided by voters, which increases staff hours and overtime during elections. Second, county election offices must notify voters of any discrepancies involving their identification information, which requires postal or digital notification to voters and segregating ballots until valid identification is provided. Lastly, county election offices must update ballot materials and envelopes and modify various elections systems, and conduct voter outreach.

Effective Date

If approved by voters at the 2026 general election, this measure takes effect upon proclamation of the Governor, no later than 30 days after the official canvass of the vote is completed.

State and Local Government Contacts

County Clerks

Secretary of State